

DENCHI NON-WOOD FOREST PRODUCT MANAGEMENT PLAN



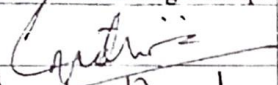
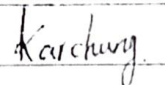
**GOMDAR GEWOG
(1st Revision)
Plan Period- 2023 to 2028**

APPROVAL SHEET

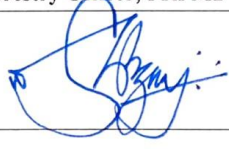
APPROVAL SHEET

Name of NWFP Management and Marketing Group:	Denchi NWFP Management and Marketing Group
Dzongkhag:	Samdrup Jongkhar
Gewog:	Gomdar
Village(s):	Denchi
No. of households:	37
Area (ha)	200ha
Plan Period:	2023-2028

Prepared and submitted for approval

	NWFP Management and Marketing Group	Gewog Administration	Social Forestry Section Head	Head of the Division/Park
Signature:				
Name:	Lupten Wangdi	Karchung	Wangchuk	Sangay Dorjee
Title:	Chairman.	Secretary	SE, FR	CEO

REVIEWED AND RECOMMENDED FOR APPROVAL

	Reviewing Officer, FRPMD	Chief Forestry Officer, FRPMD
Signature		
Name	Keang Wangmo	
Position Title	Dy. Chief Forestry Officer	

APPROVED BY



DIRECTOR
Department of Forests and Park Services, MoENR

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Section A: NWFP management and marketing plan

1. Background

Denchi village is located at a distance of 11km from the nearest Gewog center. The village formed the Non-Wood Forest Product Management and Marketing Group in 2017 with 19 households. The area selected for the group consists of rich floral and faunal biodiversity. The communities are basically agrarian and depend on subsistence agriculture and small-scale livestock farming with rearing of local breed livestock. The villages consist of mainly dry land and maize is cultivated as main staple crop by the people. Orange and ginger are the main cash crop found in the village. The community initiated to form the group to sustainably harvest and market the non-wood forest products. The NWFP species available in the area are ferns, mushroom, *Elatostema lineolatum*, *Tupistra*, *Pouzolzia* spp. *Paris polyphylla* and *Rubia cordifolia*.

1.1 The traditional rights over natural resources

The community of Denchi do not have the right over the resources and trade of resources outside their community jurisdictions. The people of neighbouring villages; Bazor, Fremo and Khoyar collect the resources from the common pool to earn income for their livelihood. The growing concern in the present is the decline of resources due to unsustainable harvesting practices causing a great threat to the resource sustainability in present and future times. Therefore, the communities came together to form a group to manage the resources sustainably and form the Non-Wood Forest Product Management and Marketing Group in the year 2017.

1.2. Review and achievement of previous management plan period

The Denchi hamlet has initially formed NWFP management group in 2017. With the completion of first phase five-year management plan period, the group is now successfully entering into the second phase of NWFP management plan by 2023.

1.2.1 Activity achievement

As per the approved management plan, the activities planned annually was implemented by the group. One of the activities was to conduct and coordinate the group meetings to update the members on the progress and achievements with regard to harvesting, marketing and financial achievement for the group as well as individual level. The group members also conduct patrolling in their non-wood forest produce collection areas and act as per the by-laws if they came across intruders and illegal collectors. The marketing of the collected non-wood forest products is sold as a group in their local and national market.

1.2.2. Financial achievement

During their past five-year plan period, the non-wood forest products collected by the communities are *Rubia cordifolia*, *Pouzolzia sp* and ferns. The collection period and quantity are collected as per the management plan prescriptions and are marketed to generate income for the community. The management group had generated Nu.20000/- (Twenty Thousand) from marketing these products. The management plan enables the NWFP collectors to access the market and improved their livelihood.

1.2.3. Problems and challenges

Besides benefits from the plan, the communities had also faced some issues and challenges while implementing their non-wood forest product management plans. Some of the challenges faced by the communities are the lack of market information. The group will need to consult relevant organization to explore market opportunities so that their raw materials/non-wood forest product can be marketed to generate income.

2. Objectives

- To ensure sustainable harvesting of NWFPs products
- To generate income through sale of NWFPs products
- To protect from illegal harvesting of NWFP products by outsiders

3. Description of NWFPs

The group members had identified several non-wood forest products that can be collected and marketed for generation of income. Some of the identified non-wood forest products are; different kinds of ferns and mushroom species, *Elatostema sp* (used as food, vegetable or ingredients for Bhutanese cuisines), *Rubia cordifolia* (natural dye), *Pouzolzi sp* (incense stick manufacturing), *Daphne sp* (traditional paper making) and *Chirata sp* (medicinal plants). The collection will be done as per the result generated from field assessment and its availability in the identified collection areas.

Table 1. Brief description of NWFPs for commercial harvesting

NWFP name	Harvesting area	Parts used	Use purpose (traditional & other)	Harvesting season (month)	Estimated quantity that can be collected
<i>Elatostema lineolatum</i> (Damuru)	Denchiphu	Stem and leaves	Vegetable	Throughout the year	1000 kg
Fern	Denchiphu	Shoot	Vegetable	Apr-Sept	5000 kg
<i>Rubia cordifolia</i> (Laniru)	Denchiphu	Entire part	dyes (color)	Nov-Feb	5000 kg
<i>Paris polyphylla</i> (Thoksampa)	Denchiphu	Rhizome	Medicine	Oct-Nov	300 kg
<i>Pouzolzia</i> spp (Yongdiba)	Denchiphu	Bark	Adhesive, Incense	Aug-Feb	3000 kg
Mushroom	Denchiphu	Entire part	Vegetable	Apr-Sept	200 kg
<i>Daphne</i> spp	Denchiphu	Bark	Traditional paper	March-June	5000 kg
<i>Viscum album</i>	Denchiphu	Twigs	Ingredient / tea	April-Sept	100 kg
Thormom (<i>Tupistra nutans</i>)	Denchiphu	Flowers	Vegetable	Oct-Nov	100 kg

4. Harvesting prescriptions for sustainable NWFP harvesting

The members will adhere to follow the guidelines and prescriptions as formulated to ensure sustainable utilization of resources and to sustain natural regeneration and resource base for present and future generations.

Table 2. Harvesting prescriptions for sustainable harvesting of NWFPs.

NWFP species	Harvesting prescription for sustainable harvesting
<i>Elatostema lineolatum</i>	• Collect plants that are 15cm and above or matured ones. • Retain stump of around 3” for sprouting of new shoots. • Do not uproot whole plant. • Should not cut down trees and create more opening

	• Should not disturb its catchment area.
Fern	• Harvest only young shoot that are 15 cm long • Do not harvest the entire shoot coming up in season • Do not harvest the shoots that have developed to leaves. • Do not cut down trees which provide shade to plant • Retain at least 50% of young shoot of last flush for development of leaves
Laniru (<i>Rubia cordifolia</i>)	• Use sharp scissors for the collection of the upper part of the plant. • Cut the plant at 5 cm above ground level. • Leave at least 10% of the plants without collecting for next time regeneration purposes • Do not collect roots • Do not uproot entire plants
Thoksampa (<i>Paris polyphylla</i>)	• Harvest the rhizome after seed dispersal • Collect between Oct- Nov (most appropriate time to emerge bud from the rhizome which remains dormant underground till next germination period) • Leave some portion of Rhizome with bud underground while harvesting.
Yongdiba (<i>Pouzolzia</i> spp)	• Cut the plant at 10 cm above the ground level • Do not damage the remaining young stands/seedlings/saplings • Felling of surrounding trees to ease harvesting is prohibited • Leave at least 10% of the plants to allow natural regeneration • Harvesting of roots is strictly prohibited for ecological reason
Mushroom	• Do not uproot entire plant • Collect only mature one leaving young one • Harvest carefully
<i>Daphne</i> spp.	• Cut the plant at 10 cm above the ground level • Cut only the stems that are 10 cm in diameter • Do not damage the remaining young stands/seedlings/saplings • Do not fell the surrounding trees in order to clear the area to ease harvesting • Harvesting should be done on rotational basis, once in 5 years for every block. • Leave at least 10% of the plants to allow natural regeneration.
<i>Swertia chirayita</i>	• Collect only after seed dispersal (generally in Nov) • Do not collect the plants in late season to avoid damaging the germination of new seedlings

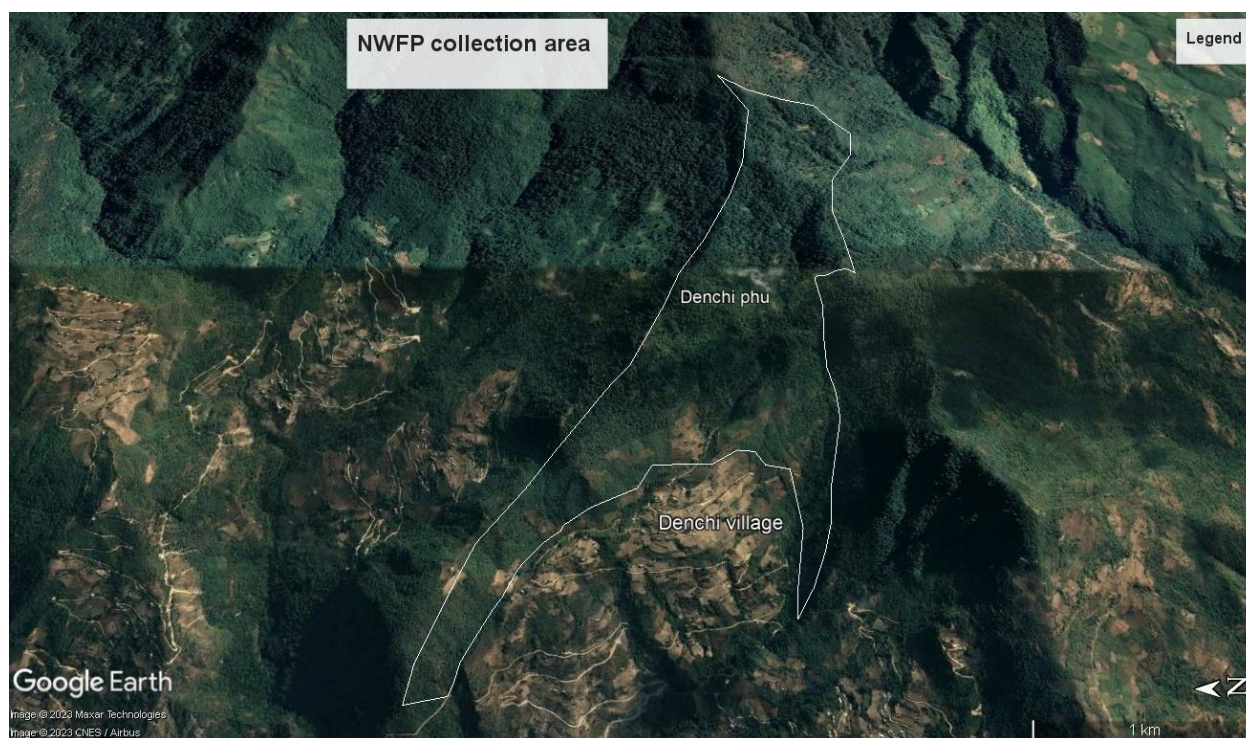


Figure 1. Boundary Map of NWFP collection area

5. Marketing and sales plan

The NWFPs can be managed substantially for domestic or commercial purposes. The marketing and trade/transit of the NWFPs through securing official permits upon paying royalties as outline in the prevailing rules. The perishable non-wood forest products collected such as mushroom, ferns etc will be sold in the local market, where as other species used for incense making, dyes, raw material for tradition paper making shall be sold to the incense factory, paper factory and other small-scale enterprises. The executive members shall also explore other market opportunities through consultation with relevant organizations.

Table 3. Marketing and sales plan

NWFPs	Potential market	Estimated quantity for sale / season (unit)	Expected selling price / unit (Nu)	Total (Nu)
<i>Elatostema lineolatum</i>	Local market, Samdrup Jongkhar town	200 kg	Nu. 25	5000
Fern shoots	Samdrup Jongkhar town / Local market	1000 kg	Nu. 20/kg	20000
<i>Paris polyphylla</i>	Samdrup Jongkhar	60 kg	Nu. 1000/kg	60000

	town /NWFPs license holder			
Yongjibu (<i>Pouzolzia</i> spp.)	NWFPs license holder	600 kg	Nu.30/kg	18000
<i>Viscum album</i>	Local / SJ Throm/ Narphung	20 kg	Nu.100/kg	2000
<i>Daphne</i> spp		1000 kg	Nu. 20/kg	20000
<i>Rubia cordifolia</i>	Samdrup Jongkhar Throm / NWFP license holder	1000 kg	Nu.40/kg	40000
<i>Mushroom</i>	Local market	50 kg	150/kg	7500
<i>Dioscorea</i> sp (Borang juktang)	Local market	100 kg	50 kg	5000

6. Marketing arrangements

- The group members with prior permission from the chairperson and the committee members, collect the non-wood forest products as per the management prescription provided for each species.
- The quantity of products trading to market will be assessed by the chairperson and secretary to ensure proper recording and payments in the registered community group account.
- The collected non-wood forest products are then marketed individually or in a group based on the interest of the group members.

7. Benefits to the members

Any members of the group can earn income through sale of collected non-wood forest products. The members of the group have the right to get equal share from the accumulated group fund and they shall be responsible to look after the welfare of the incompetent members. Through the formation of the group, it will also provide support in terms of improving the capacities of the group members and knowledge expansion.

8. Benefits to the group

- Easy access to permits for NWFP harvesting and marketing
- Reduce illegal harvesting practice of NWFPs.
- Opportunity in creation of community development fund through the sale of NWFPs.

9. NWFPS HARVESTING CALENDER

Harvesting year	Name of Collecting area	Remarks
1 st Year	Denchi Phu	Harvesting of products like ferns can be collected throughout the season as per management prescription
2 nd Year	Omphu	
3 rd Year	Denchi phu	
4 th Year	Omphu	
5 th Year	Denchi phu	

Section B: By-laws

10. Members of the NWFP management & marketing group

Village	Number of member households	Gewog
Denchi	38	Gomdor
Membership arrangement and rights of members: ➤ Only the residents of Denchi village with definite gung and census are eligible to become a member of NWFPS mgt. group. ➤ Membership of the group is defined by Denchi village ➤ If he/she fragmented from same gung and wanted to become as separate new member can become a member after paying entry fee of Nu.100 (one hundred) only. ➤ The person wishing to join the group must apply to chairperson. His/her membership would be decided by the group members during the general assembly and then make aware of group's objectives, plan and by-laws. ➤ The residents of same village who is not a member and later if a resident wants to become a member, he/she can become a member after paying sum of entry fee and total accumulated budget divided by total members ➤ Any member wishing to opt-out from membership due to genuine problem or reason (resettlement program) shall be entitled 50 percent of individual share from the common fund. ➤ Any member on purposely withdraws from the group member shall not entertain any benefits and forest resources from the NWFPS delineated areas base on the traditional boundaries. ➤ The members have right to terminate/re-elect the executive members if misuse their responsibilities.		
Responsibilities of members: ➤ Active participation in meetings, trainings and also in general assembly twice a year. ➤ All members should participate in protection, sustainable management and harvesting of		

NWFPs.

- The entire group member will actively participate in patrolling their NWFPs growing areas twice a year on rotational basis.
- Inform/avail permit from chairperson for collection of NWFPs and provide correct information for proper recording after marketing.
- Members must follow annual harvesting calendar.
- Harvest, manage and utilized the NWFPs on sustainable basis as per the management guidelines and prescriptions.
- Report promptly of any illegal encounter case to chairperson and committees for action

11. Executive committee members and their responsibilities

✓ The 3 elected executive committee members will act as representatives of the NWFP Group pertaining to the management and utilization of the resources. ✓ The terms for these executive committee members were fixed for the period of five years without the incentives. However, they can resign or terminated before the completion of their terms if their performances are not satisfactory. ✓ The termination or resignation of executive committee will take place during the general assembly and the NWFP group members will approve the termination/resignation from the executive membership and nominate/elect the substitution through voting system.	
Chairperson	Name of Chairperson: Lungten Wangdi
	Responsibilities of Coordinator/Chairperson: ➤ Chair the meeting related to NWFPs management, utilization and marketing. ➤ Work in close coordination with other organizations, sectors and agencies, and seek assistance for the development of management group. ➤ To arrange and coordinate the marketing of NWFPs and handicraft items. ➤ Represent the group in meetings that will take place in other parts of the country and share information and ideas acquired from the meeting with the group members. ➤ Resolve disputes and conflicts arising among the group members and maintain good working relations. ➤ Coordinate the patrolling of NWFPs prevailing areas from time to time on rotational basis. ➤ Initiate annual planning and progress report submission to Gewog Forest Ranger and Chief Forest Officer through RO. ➤ Jointly sign with the Secretary and Treasurer on the cheque during the withdrawal of community fund.

Secretary	Name of Secretary: Sangay Wangmo
	Responsibilities Secretary: ➤ Officiate the chairperson in his absence. ➤ Inform the date, time and venue of meeting to all the group members. ➤ Keep minutes of NWFPs related meetings and make presentation at the end. ➤ Assist the chairperson in solving conflicts arising among members and maintain good working relations, and also in marketing of NWFPs. ➤ Keep proper record and data of NWFPs collected and marketed. ➤ Jointly sign with the Chairperson and Treasurer on the cheque during the withdrawal of community fund.
Treasurer	Name of Treasurer: Yejay Norbu
	Responsibilities Treasurer: ➤ Keep proper records and accountings of NWFPs and assist the chairperson and secretary in marketing. ➤ Issue a receipt to the individual for quantity of NWFPs collected for sale. ➤ Keep annual financial transaction records and present to the group members during the general assembly. ➤ Collect and deposit the money in the NWFPs group account maintained with the nearest financial institution. ➤ Jointly sign with the Chairperson and Secretary on the cheque during the withdrawal of community fund.
Possible additional executive committee members	Responsibilities: ➤ Assist the chairperson, secretary and treasurer in implementation of NWFPs management plan and group by-laws ➤ Provide help in coordinating of NWFPs collection and marketing ➤ Assist the chairperson, secretary and treasurer during the arrival of visitors and guests
Compensation to the executive committee for marketing	The community has unanimously decided to do away with the payment of the compensation practice to the executive committee members for marketing services. The committee along with few group members will work on rotational basis for the benefit of all the community members without any incentives.
Membership fee and purpose	Every member shall contribute annual membership fee of Nu. 50 (fifty) only. The amount will be deposited in the nearest bank and utilized the accumulated amount for the welfare of the NWFPs group members in the near future. The amount can even use for pre-financing the marketing cost of NWFPs.

12. Fund utilization

Community development fund	The community development fund will be generated through following means; ➤ Membership fees collection ➤ Sale of NWFPs like ferns, mushrooms, damroo, <i>Rubia</i>, <i>Pouzolzia</i> species etc. 5% deduction of the total sale value of the NWFPs from every individual ➤ Fines and penalties of absentees and illegal doers ➤ Contribution and donation from visitors and other relevant agencies.
Fund Utilization	The accumulated common fund will be managed & utilized for the welfare of group members as follows; ➤ The common fund generating from above means will maintain in the group saving account with the BDBL. ➤ Whether to give loan to the needy member or not will be decided during the annual general assembly and accordingly frame separate internal rules and regulations. ➤ The fund will be utilized for the procurement of office stationeries, seals, printing of permits books, money receipt etc. In order to meet the small internal expenses, either the chairperson or the secretary has authority to keep the community fund of Nu. 3000 (three thousand) only in their hands. For any further changes, the issue will discuss during the annual general assembly in future.

13. Conflict Management

Conflict resolution	➤ The chairperson and the secretary shall solve the conflict arising among the group members. ➤ If the conflict arises between executive committee members and the group members, the matter shall be forwarded to Chiwog Tshogpa followed by Gewog Forestry staff and Gewog Administration by chairperson for final decision. ➤ If the problem arises between group members and the outsiders, the matter shall directly forward to the Gewog Administration for settlement followed by Dzongkhag Administration if it is not solved at gewog level.
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14. Penalties

Collection or harvesting of NWFPs for home consumption purposes will be free of royalty while for commercial purposes will face certain percentage deductions towards community development fund from the total sales of every individual. However, the fines and penalties against the illegal doers will be imposed both for group members as well as non-members in the

following ways;		
Sl.No	Name of NWFPs	Fines and penalties for illegal collection
1	<i>Daphne</i> sp	Nu. 20 per kg& seize
2	Mushroom spp.	Nu. 20 per kg seize
3	Fern shoots	Nu. 10 per bundle & seize
4	<i>Rubia</i> spp. (Lanero)+ Yongjibu	Nu. 50 per kg & seize
5	<i>Viscum album</i>	Nu. 40 per kg& seize (Raw) Nu. 100 per kg & seize (value added)
6	<i>Elatostema lineolatum</i>	Nu.15 per kg & seize
7	Harvesting from un-identified locations	Nu. 100 & seize
8	If illegal collection of any NWFPs not listed in the mgt. plan	As per the FNCRR with kind support from the forestry officials
Other norms and penalties of the group members		
9	Misuse of fund by the executive committee members	Should repay the amount with existing bank interest rate
10	If any committee members fail to deliver service	Terminate him/her and appoint new ones through voting system
11	Failure to attend meeting	Nu.300
12	Failure to attend work	Nu. 300

Annexure 1. Lists of NWFP group members

SERIAL NO	Name	CID NO.	Contact No	Signature
1	Nangay Wangchuk	11102002381	77578692	(1)
2	Yegay Norbu	11102002350	77274327 17954858	YH
3	Sonam Tashi	11102002165	17927723	(3)
4	Kanga	11102002122	17559339	(4)
5	Ngyag Norbu	11102002357	77466818	(5)
6	Ugyen Cham	11102002275	17838807	(6)
7	Tshomo	11102002277	77220089	(7)
8	Changlu	11102002370	17339098	(8)
9	Kuenzang Wangmo	11102002264	77876300	(9)
10	Sangay Wangmo	11102002272	77426185	(10)
11	Gutong	11102002263	77423143	(11) (12)
12	Ngyawang Norbu	11102002312	17881155	(12)
13	Tandin Wangchuk	11102002226	77601217 17880767	(13)

14	Tashi	11102002367	17987600	(14)
15	Lungten Wangdi	11102002226	17686445	(15)
16	Singye Wangchuk	11102002208	17844249	(16)
17	Tashi Wangchuk	11102002151	77554408	(17)
18	Sonam Norbu	11102002426	77899768	(18)
19	Dorji Tenzin	11102002806	17455362	(19)
20	Sangay Dorji	11102002463	77351490	(20)
21	Dema	11102002215	17875629	(21)
22	Sangay Wangchuk	11102002309	77666173	(22)
23	Tshewang Dorji	11102002342	77409477	(23)
24	Tandin Tshering	11102002151	77443754	(24)
25	Norbu	1110200	17387109	(25)

One day NWFP Mgt Group Consultation Meeting				
SL/No	Name	CID NO.	Contact No	Signature
26	Thinly Yoezer	11102002460	17308362	
27	Soram Wangdi	11102002293	17230269	20
28	Sangay Wangdi	1110200283	17990208	27
29	Ngawang Tenzin	11102002554	77479546	
30	Rinzin Wangchuk	11102002377	77872518	
31	Youten Jamtsho	11102002155	77228701	
32	Lungten Tshering	11102002394	77203573	32
33	Kuenzang Chogyal Tshering	11102002400	17339344	
34	Ugyen Wangchuk	11102002452	17518048	
35	Tenda	11102002801	77274367	
36	Karma	11102002442	17838587	
37	Sangay Tenzin	11102002416	7740473866	
38				

39
40.

डेन्चि
मैनेजमेन्ट